

CR Micro (688396.SS): Margin expansion on improving UT rate; Enjoying end market expansion; Neutral

CR Micro's 2Q26 revenue was in line with our estimate and Bloomberg consensus, while GM was higher than our estimate, which we attribute to the product price increase and utilization rate improvement. 2Q26 opex ratio was better than our estimate, reflecting the operational efficiency improvement as revenue scales up. Overall, 2Q26 net income was up 53% YoY / 18% QoQ to Rmb390m, or 18% / 19% higher than our estimate / Bloomberg consensus, reflecting the company's improving profitability. We remain positive on the company's growth ahead and expect the company's revenue to grow at 25% YoY to Rmb3.5bn in 3Q26, along with the continuous GM improvement, supported by (1) AI server shipments ramp-up driving CR Micro's power semi business growth, (2) end-market diversification towards optical modules, AI server power supply, robotics, etc, (3) foundry and OSAT utilization rate improvement driving margin expansion. Maintain Neutral relative to coverage.

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Exhibit 1: 2Q26 result snapshot

(Rmb mn)	2Q26 Actual	2Q26 GS	Diff	1Q26	QoQ	2Q25	YoY	2Q26 Con. Act. / Con.
Revenue	3,271	3,253	1%	2,857	14%	2,863	14%	3,276 0%
Gross profit	903	879	3%	728	24%	743	22%	899 1%
Operating income	426	377	13%	256	67%	278	53%	369 15%
Net income	390	330	18%	330	18%	256	53%	329 19%
Margins								
Gross margin	27.6%	27.0%		25.5%		25.9%		27.4%
Operating margin	13.0%	11.6%		8.9%		9.7%		11.3%
Net margin	11.9%	10.1%		11.5%		8.9%		10.0%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

Earnings revision: We factor in CR Micro's 2Q26 results and revise up our 2026E net income by 2%, mainly on higher GM and lower opex ratio. Our 2026E GM is revised up to reflect the utilization rate improvement, and opex ratio is revised down to reflect the company's rising operational efficiency as revenue scales up. Our 2027-28E estimates are largely unchanged.

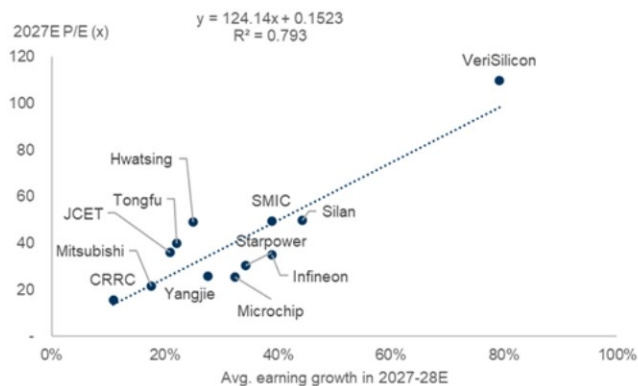
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Exhibit 2: Earnings revision

(Rmb mn)	New	2026E Old	Diff	New	2027E Old	Diff	New	2028E Old	Diff
Revenue	13,337	13,319	0%	16,390	16,372	0%	19,153	19,135	0%
Gross profit	3,742	3,718	1%	4,685	4,676	0%	5,634	5,629	0%
Operating income	1,612	1,576	2%	2,327	2,317	0%	3,260	3,255	0%
Net income	1,506	1,484	2%	2,012	2,005	0%	2,739	2,734	0%
Margins									
Gross margin	28.1%	27.9%	0.1ppts	28.6%	28.6%	0ppts	29.4%	29.4%	0ppts
Operating margin	12.1%	11.8%	0.3ppts	14.2%	14.2%	0ppts	17.0%	17.0%	0ppts
Net margin	11.3%	11.1%	0.2ppts	12.3%	12.2%	0ppts	14.3%	14.3%	0ppts

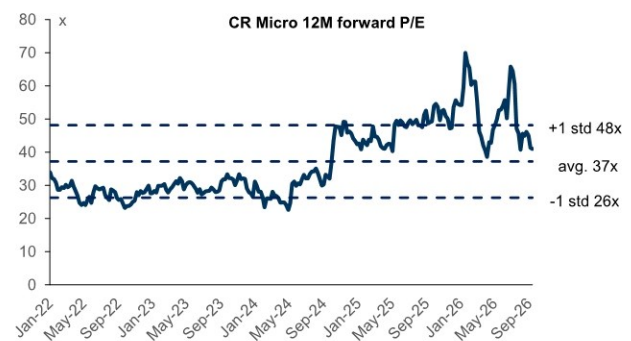
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: We continue to use forward target P/E to derive our 12M TP. Our target P/E is unchanged at 37.4x 2028E EPS, which is still derived from peers' correlation between trading P/E and forward year NI YoY. Our peer group includes global power semis suppliers and China AI semis players, including IC design, foundry, OSAT, etc, that benefits from rising AI semi end demand. With the updated target P/E and earnings estimates, our 12M TP is unchanged at Rmb77.02. **Maintain Neutral.**

Exhibit 3: CR Micro's peers: avg. NI growth in 2027E-28E and 2027E P/E

Refinitiv Eikon consensus estimates for Tongfu, Yangjie, and Silan

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Refinitiv Eikon

Exhibit 4: CR Micro 12M forward P/E

Source: Refinitiv Eikon

Exhibit 5: CR Micro P&L summary

(Rmb m)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	2,355	2,863	2,851	2,985	2,857	3,271	3,561	3,647	10,060	9,901	10,119	11,054	13,337	16,390	19,153
Gross profit	596	743	795	783	728	903	1,039	1,072	3,694	3,190	2,752	2,916	3,742	4,685	5,634
Operating expense	474	465	525	556	473	477	577	603	1,733	2,060	1,932	2,020	2,130	2,358	2,374
Operating income	121	278	270	227	256	426	463	468	1,961	1,130	820	896	1,612	2,327	3,260
Net income	83	256	187	135	330	390	390	396	2,617	1,479	762	661	1,506	2,012	2,739
EPS (Rmb)	0.06	0.19	0.14	0.10	0.25	0.29	0.29	0.30	1.98	1.12	0.58	0.50	1.13	1.52	2.06
Margins / ratio															
Gross margin	25.3%	25.9%	27.9%	26.2%	25.5%	27.6%	29.2%	29.4%	36.7%	32.2%	27.2%	26.4%	28.1%	28.6%	29.4%
Opex ratio	20.1%	16.2%	18.4%	18.6%	16.5%	14.6%	16.2%	16.5%	17.2%	20.8%	19.1%	18.3%	16.0%	14.4%	12.4%
Operating margin	5.1%	9.7%	9.5%	7.6%	8.9%	13.0%	13.0%	12.8%	19.5%	11.4%	8.1%	8.1%	12.1%	14.2%	17.0%
Net margin	3.4%	9.7%	7.9%	4.7%	13.7%	13.3%	13.2%	13.1%	26.4%	17.0%	7.9%	6.5%	13.3%	15.1%	17.8%
QoQ															
Revenue	-11%	22%	0%	5%	-4%	14%	9%	2%							
Gross profit	-18%	25%	7%	-1%	-7%	24%	15%	3%							
Operating income	-54%	130%	-3%	-16%	13%	67%	9%	1%							
Net income	-68%	207%	-27%	-28%	144%	18%	0%	2%							
EPS	-68%	207%	-27%	-28%	144%	18%	0%	2%							
YoY															
Revenue	11%	8%	5%	13%	21%	14%	25%	22%	9%	-2%	2%	9%	21%	23%	17%
Gross profit	6%	7%	3%	8%	22%	22%	31%	37%	13%	-14%	-14%	6%	28%	25%	20%
Operating income	56%	27%	3%	-13%	111%	53%	71%	107%	3%	-42%	-27%	9%	80%	44%	40%
Net income	151%	3%	-15%	-49%	297%	53%	109%	194%	15%	-43%	-48%	-13%	128%	34%	36%
EPS	150%	3%	-15%	-49%	296%	53%	109%	194%	12%	-43%	-49%	-14%	128%	34%	36%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - CR Micro

Valuation methodology: Our 12-month target price of **Rmb77.02** is based on 37.4x 2028E P/E. Our target multiple is derived from sector P/E and earnings growth correlation. Our target P/E is within CR Micro's historical trading range.

Upside / downside risks include: (1) Stronger / weaker-than-expected AI infrastructure end demand; (2) Higher / lower-than-expected yield rate; (3) Stronger / milder-than-expected market competition.

688396.SS

12m Price Target: Rmb77.02

Price: Rmb57.86

Upside: 33.1%

Neutral

GS Forecast

Market cap: Rmb76.6bn / \$11.4bn
Enterprise value:
Rmb68.2bn / \$10.2bn
3m ADTV: Rmb2.0bn / \$294.5mn
China
Greater China Technology
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

Revenue (Rmb mn) New

Revenue (Rmb mn) Old

EBITDA (Rmb mn)

EPS (Rmb) New

EPS (Rmb) Old

P/E (X)

P/B (X)

Dividend yield (%)

CROCI (%)

6/26

9/26E

12/26E

3/27E

EPS (Rmb)

12/25

12/26E

12/27E

12/28E

11,053.8

13,337.3

16,389.8

19,152.6

11,053.8

13,319.2

16,371.8

19,134.6

2,149.4

3,166.0

3,973.2

4,960.6

0.50

1.14

1.52

2.06

0.50

1.12

1.51

2.06

97.8

50.9

38.2

28.0

2.8

3.2

3.0

2.7

0.2

0.3

0.4

0.6

5.5

7.0

7.8

8.8

0.30

0.29

0.30

0.27

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 16 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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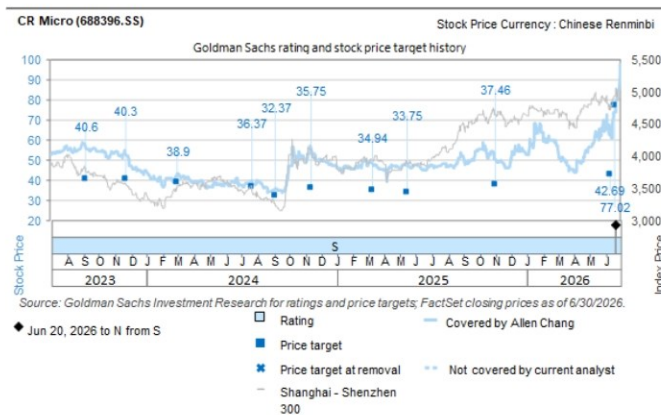
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Target price history table(s)

CR Micro (688396.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
20-Jun-26	77.02	73.59
10-Jun-26	42.69	63.83
02-Nov-25	37.46	50.74
16-May-25	33.75	47.99
12-Mar-25	34.94	47.85
12-Nov-24	35.75	56.13
06-Sep-24	32.37	35.30
22-Jul-24	36.37	39.98
02-Mar-24	38.90	43.38
23-Nov-23	40.30	52.51

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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